

Thursday night, two-minute noodles.

Friday night . . . you get the point.

So next up, you're going to get your kids to put their new signature dish into action . . . by hosting a dinner party.

It's party time!

Let your teenager know that for the next Money Meal they'll be hosting a dinner party . . . so they're in charge.

(If you have more than one teen, they should each host their own party over the coming months. And if you have younger kids, it's your call whether to do this now or postpone it for a few years.)

Tell them you'll give them a \$30 budget for the shop (adjust up or down if you need to).

Then they'll be running the show from start to finish:

- They'll decide who they want to invite (grandparents are great for this, but if that doesn't work, feel free to invite relatives, family friends, or even their own friends).
- They'll check the pantry and prepare a shopping list.
- They'll go shopping for what they need for the meal (get them to keep their receipt for later, you'll need it).
- And finally, they'll prepare, cook and serve the meal!

This real-world experience is going to teach them how expensive running a family is, how much work is required in putting on a nightly meal and, most importantly, why you lose your mind when your kids thumb their noses at what you've cooked.

When the dinner party rolls around, you get to kick back and relax—your teen's running the show. (Though you'll probably have to be on hand for advice, and be ready with the fire extinguisher.)